Portfolio Projects for BUSINESS COMMUNICATIONS

Chapter 8

Proposals

NEW PERSPECTIVES



Objectives

- Identify proposal types
- Develop proposal content
- Structure a proposal
- Format a proposal
- Outline a document in Word

Others…

- Generate a table of contents in Word
- Create sections in a Word document
- Insert headers, footers, and page numbers in Word

Introduction

- Proposals are written to **persuade the reader to take a specific course of action** when a situation requires effort and cost

Why write proposals

Reason	Example
To present a new idea to another company or within your own company	Obtain permission to develop a new 10-month certificate program called *Executive Administration* at a local college or university
To request funding for a project you want to complete	Obtain funding from a local government to hold an arts fair in the community; the government may supply forms that the proposer must complete with the proposal information
To propose a partnership with another individual or company	Obtain agreement from a small business to provide ongoing Web support
To request a contract to complete a specific project or job	Obtain a contract to write the policy and procedure manual for a large franchise

Figure 8-1 Reasons for writing proposals

Proposal types

Proposal Type	Description
Solicited Proposal	• Write a solicited proposal in response to a specific request. For example, your supervisor may ask you to submit your idea about reorganizing the entire filing system in your office in the form of a proposal.
Unsolicited Proposal	• Write an unsolicited proposal to individuals or companies that might be interested in what you have to offer. For example, write a proposal to describe the landscaping services or Web design and maintenance services you can offer to a company.
Request for Proposal (RFP)	• Write a proposal in response to a formal Request for Proposal (RFP) distributed by companies and government agencies. For example, the organizing committee of a city that has won the bid to host the Olympics would develop RFPs for a wide variety of projects—from the construction of a new stadium, ski run, and arena, to the creation of an Olympic mascot and the training of volunteers. Companies respond using the format specified with a proposal that specifically addresses the needs outlined in the RFP.

Figure 8-2 Proposal types

Formal/ informal proposal

- A formal proposal (long and detailed)
- An informal proposal is a brief document (2-4 pages)

Purpose

- Developing proposal content
  - Ultimate purpose is **to win** the contract, obtain funding, get the job, etc.
    - Everything written should reflect this
    - Present information to persuade the reader

Content (audience)

- Developing proposal content (cont'd.)
  - To determine content, ask:
    - **What** are you proposing?
    - **Who** has requested the proposal?
    - What **need** does your proposal address?
    - What does the reader **want**?
    - What is your **competition** (if any) doing?

Content (writer)

- Developing proposal content (cont'd.)
  - To determine content, ask:
    - What are the characteristics of the product or service you are offering?
    - What qualifications do you have to meet the needs of the proposal?
    - What is the timeline for the project?
    - How much will the proposed project cost?

Question	Answer
What are you proposing?	To build a new playground containing safety-tested playground equipment for the children at Oak Park Elementary School.
Who requested the proposal?	The Oak Park School Board requested the proposal from the Oak Park Parent Advisory Council (OPPAC). The Board has not issued a formal Request for Proposal (RFP) to which other organizations could respond.
What need does the proposal meet?	The current playground is in a state of disrepair. Most of the swings are broken, the slide is cracked, and the old-fashioned metal climbing structure is unsafe. Several injuries have occurred in recent years as the result of the substandard equipment.
What does the reader want?	The school board wants to build a new playground for a reasonable cost that will provide safe recreational opportunities for children attending the school.
What is the competition doing?	A new playground similar to the playground proposed for Oak Park Elementary School was recently built at Arbutus Court Elementary School. This playground will be a model for the playground proposed for Oak Park.
What are the characteristics of the product or service you are offering?	The new playground consists of two sets of 10 swings, a large adventure playground structure with capacity for 20 children, and four coil spring rides. A detailed description of the new playground, including models and photographs of the Arbutus Court playground, will be included.

Figure 8-3 Identifying content for a proposal

Question	Answer
What qualifications do you have?	Marcus Watson is a professional architect with a practice in Portland. Mr. Watson is also a member of OPPAC and has agreed to donate his time to design the new playground. In addition, OPPAC can call upon up to 50 volunteers to do the work. A professional contractor will be hired and the entire project will be supervised by a school board inspector.
How much will the project cost?	The total cost will be $68,750 for the materials and labor. The architect and OPPAC members will be donating their time to save costs.

Figure 8-3 Identifying content for a proposal (cont'd.)

Structure

- Organize proposal into the following sections:
  - Introduction
  - Description of Needs
  - Scope of the Project
  - Methods and Procedures
  - Detailed Work Plan and Schedule
  - Qualifications of the Company or Individual
  - Projected Costs
  - Conclusion
  - Other Components (such as Appendices)

Introduction

- Describe purpose of proposed project and indicate major topics

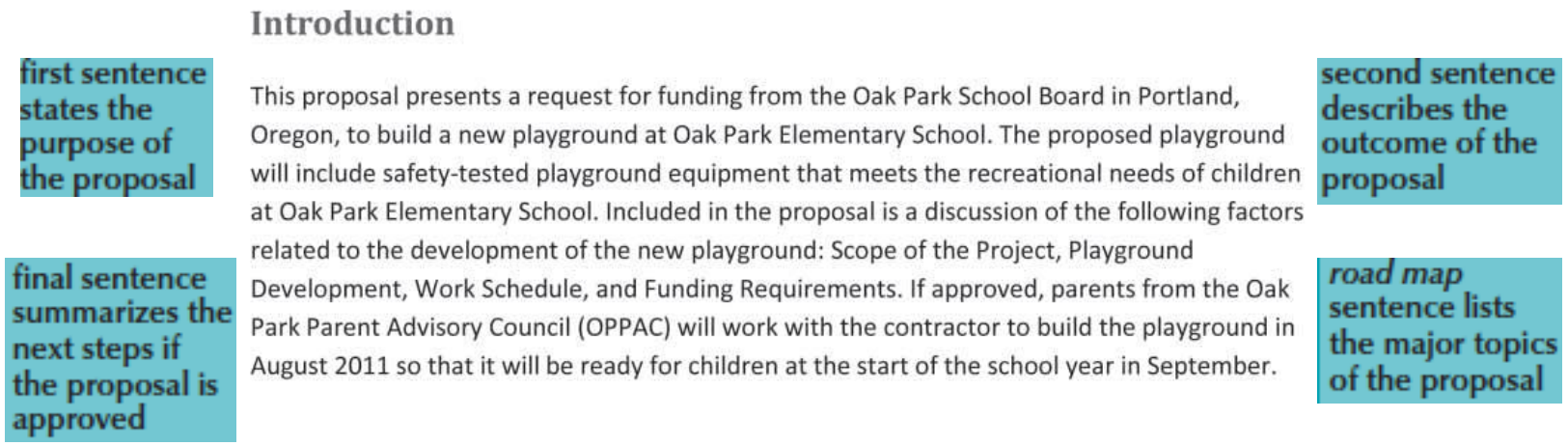


Figure 8-4 Introduction to playground proposal

Description of needs

- Description of Need
  - Includes background information the reader requires to understand the need for proposed project

Scope

- Scope of the Project
  - Describes **limits** of the project and details about dates and personnel
  - May include subsections describing individual components of the project

Scope of the Project

scope of the proposed project

The proposed playground consists of two sets of 10 swings, a large adventure playground style structure with capacity for 20 children, and four coil spring rides. The following components are required to build and maintain the new playground:

specific components related to the proposed project

- Final approval of the playground design created by Marcus Watson, a professional architect and a member of OPPAC
- Purchase of materials
- Hiring of a paid contractor to oversee the building of the playground
- Allocation of duties to volunteers from OPPAC to assist with the building
- Development of a maintenance program to be implemented by employees of the Oak Park School District

reference to a model for the project

The Parent Advisory Council at Arbutus Court Elementary School recently built a new playground similar to the playground proposed for Oak Park Elementary School. This playground will be a model for the playground proposed for Oak Park.

Figure 8-5 Sample Scope of the Project section for the playground proposal

Methods/Schedule

- Methods and Procedures
  - Tells exactly what you plan to do to complete the project
  - Includes information about personnel, equipment, materials, and any other relevant factors
- Detailed Work Plan and Schedule
  - Required if project needs to be completed in a certain time frame

More on content…

- Qualifications of Company or Individual
  - Describe qualifications and background of key players in the project
- Projected Costs
  - Present cost information clearly and succinctly
- Conclusion
  - Summarize proposal rationale and stress benefits

Appendices

- Other Components
  - Appendix or appendices contain information too detailed to be included in proposal body

Generating a Table of Contents

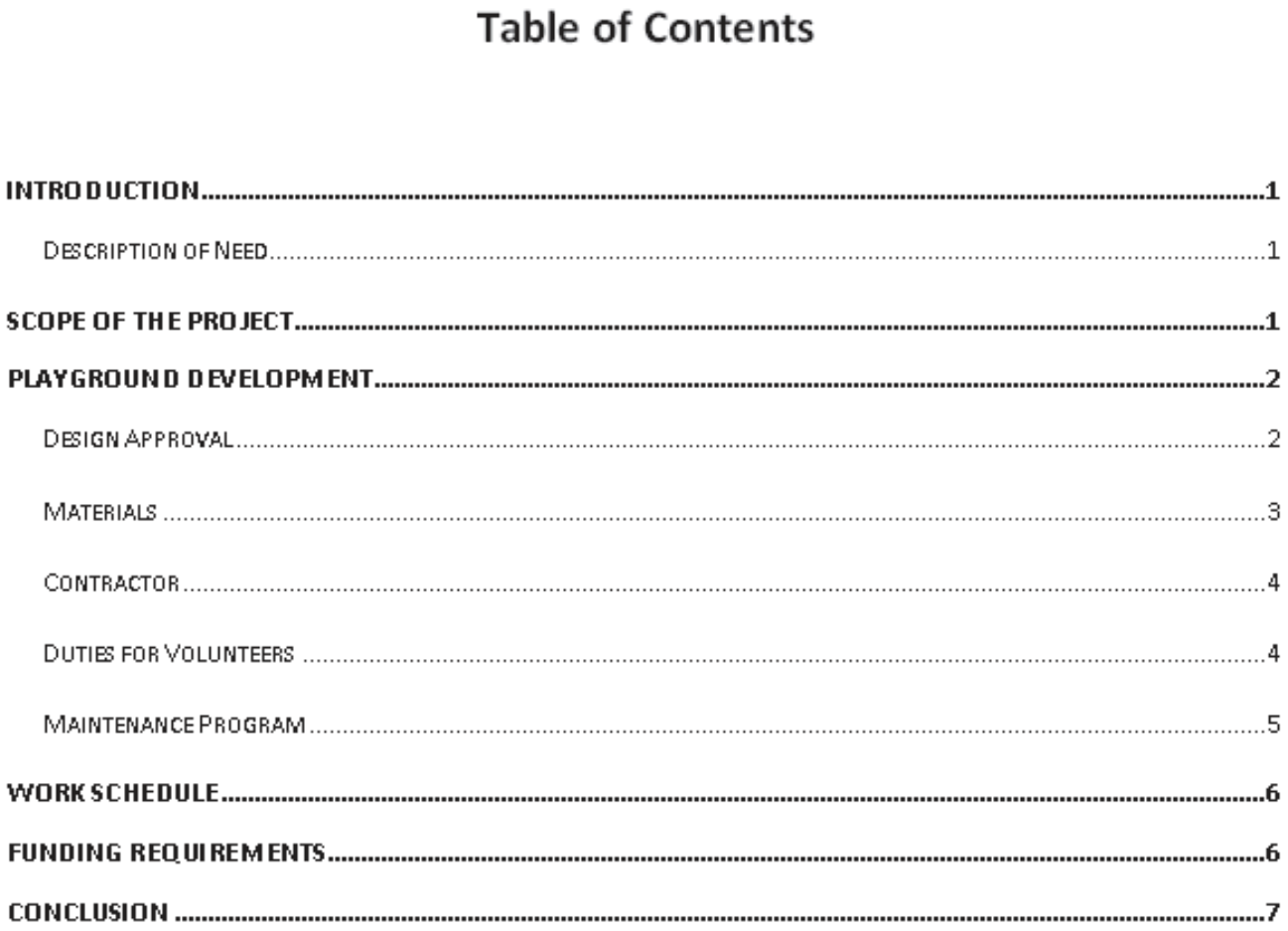


Table of Contents

INTRODUCTION **1**

DESCRIPTION OF NEED 1

SCOPE OF THE PROJECT **1**

PLAYGROUND DEVELOPMENT **2**

DESIGN APPROVAL 2

MATERIALS 3

CONTRACTOR 4

DUTIES FOR VOLUNTEERS 4

MAINTENANCE PROGRAM 5

WORK SCHEDULE **6**

FUNDING REQUIREMENTS **6**

CONCLUSION **7**

Figure 8-6 Table of Contents for the playground proposal

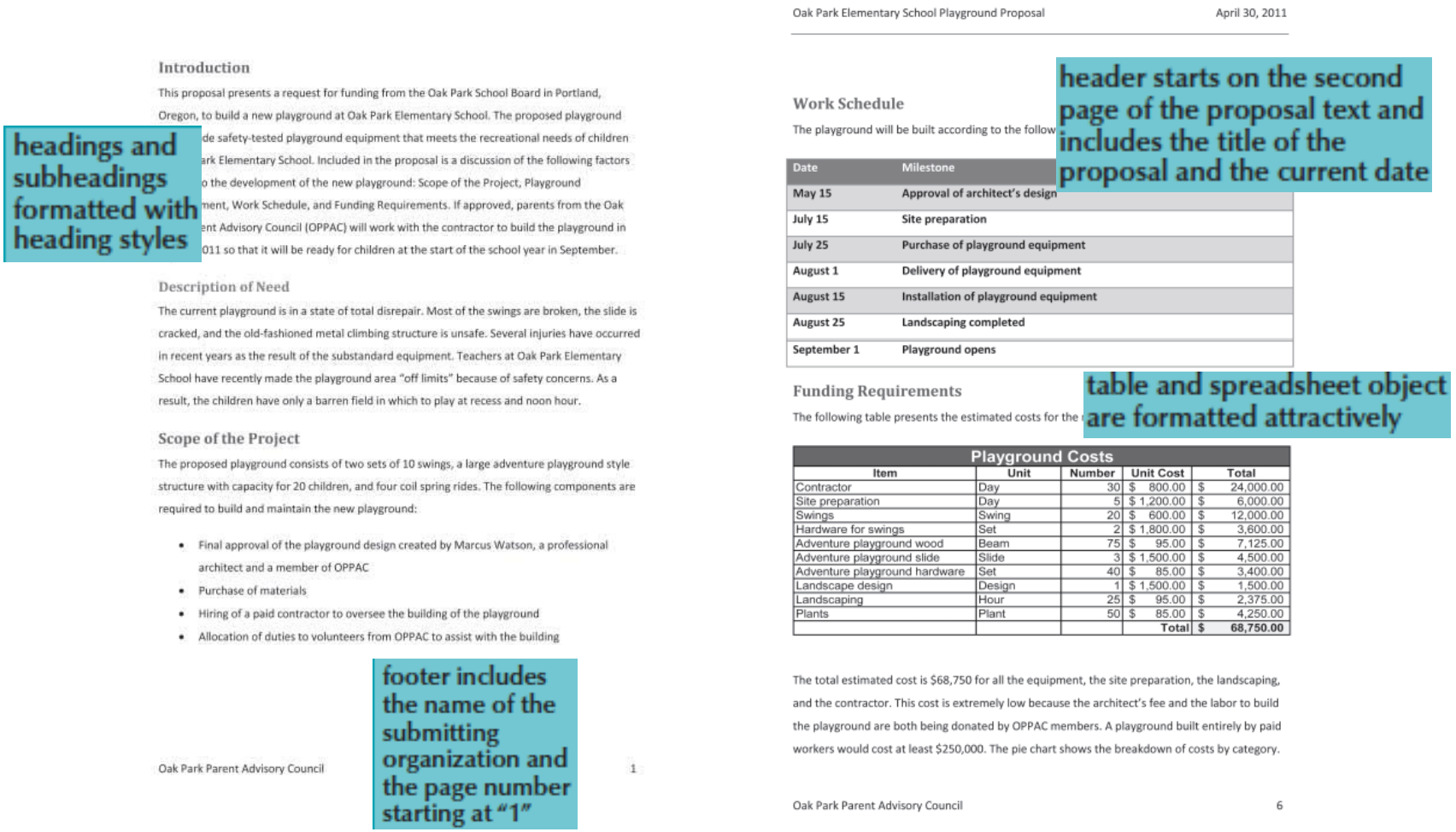
Formatting

- Proposals consists of multiple pages
  - Need to format pages clearly and attractively

Component	Description
Title Page	• Include the title of the proposal, the name and title of the person or company who will receive the proposal, the name and title of the person who is submitting the proposal, and the current date. • Include a picture or a graphic such as a company logo, if appropriate. • Format the title page so that all the text is easy to read and attractively spaced; use a large font size for the proposal title.
Table of Contents	• List the principal headings and subheadings included in the proposal. • Use Word to generate a table of contents that you can update automatically. • Format the table of contents attractively, including using leader lines to help the readers associate a heading entry with a page number.
Header and Footer	• Create a header that includes the title of the proposal and the date and appears on the second and subsequent pages of the proposal text. • Create a footer for the table of contents page that includes the name of the individual or organization submitting the proposal at the left margin and the page number formatted as a lowercase Roman numeral at the right margin. • Modify the footer for the first and subsequent pages of the proposal text so that it includes the name of the submitting body at the left margin and the page number formatted in Arabic numerals beginning at *1* from the right margin.
Headings with Styles	• Use heading styles to format all the headings and subheadings in the proposal text consistently.
Tables and Graphics	• Format tables and other graphic elements, such as charts and illustrations, so that they are easy to read and understand.

Figure 8-7 Guidelines for formatting a proposal

Proposal Essentials (cont'd.)



Introduction

This proposal presents a request for funding from the Oak Park School Board in Portland, Oregon, to build a new playground at Oak Park Elementary School. The proposed playground de safety-tested playground equipment that meets the recreational needs of children ark Elementary School. Included in the proposal is a discussion of the following factors o the development of the new playground: Scope of the Project, Playground ment, Work Schedule, and Funding Requirements. If approved, parents from the Oak ent Advisory Council (OPPAC) will work with the contractor to build the playground in 011 so that it will be ready for children at the start of the school year in September.

Description of Need

The current playground is in a state of total disrepair. Most of the swings are broken, the slide is cracked, and the old-fashioned metal climbing structure is unsafe. Several injuries have occurred in recent years as the result of the substandard equipment. Teachers at Oak Park Elementary School have recently made the playground area "off limits" because of safety concerns. As a result, the children have only a barren field in which to play at recess and noon hour.

Scope of the Project

The proposed playground consists of two sets of 10 swings, a large adventure playground style structure with capacity for 20 children, and four coil spring rides. The following components are required to build and maintain the new playground:

- Final approval of the playground design created by Marcus Watson, a professional architect and a member of OPPAC
- Purchase of materials
- Hiring of a paid contractor to oversee the building of the playground
- Allocation of duties to volunteers from OPPAC to assist with the building

Oak Park Parent Advisory Council 1

Oak Park Elementary School Playground Proposal April 30, 2011

Work Schedule

The playground will be built according to the follow

Date	Milestone
May 15	Approval of architect's design
July 15	Site preparation
July 25	Purchase of playground equipment
August 1	Delivery of playground equipment
August 15	Installation of playground equipment
August 25	Landscaping completed
September 1	Playground opens

Funding Requirements

The following table presents the estimated costs for the

Playground Costs				
Item	Unit	Number	Unit Cost	Total
Contractor	Day	30	$ 800.00	$ 24,000.00
Site preparation	Day	5	$ 1,200.00	$ 6,000.00
Swings	Swing	20	$ 600.00	$ 12,000.00
Hardware for swings	Set	2	$ 1,800.00	$ 3,600.00
Adventure playground wood	Beam	75	$ 95.00	$ 7,125.00
Adventure playground slide	Slide	3	$ 1,500.00	$ 4,500.00
Adventure playground hardware	Set	40	$ 85.00	$ 3,400.00
Landscape design	Design	1	$ 1,500.00	$ 1,500.00
Landscaping	Hour	25	$ 95.00	$ 2,375.00
Plants	Plant	50	$ 85.00	$ 4,250.00
			Total	$ 68,750.00

The total estimated cost is $68,750 for all the equipment, the site preparation, the landscaping, and the contractor. This cost is extremely low because the architect's fee and the labor to build the playground are both being donated by OPPAC members. A playground built entirely by paid workers would cost at least $250,000. The pie chart shows the breakdown of costs by category.

Oak Park Parent Advisory Council 6

Figure 8-8 Pages 1 and 6 of the sample proposal text

Technology Skills
Organizing Content in Word

- Outline view in Word helps develop document structure and generate a Table of Contents to list headings and subheadings
- Outlining feature in Word:
  - Designed to help keep track of how topics and subtopics fit together
  - Sort content into headings, subheadings, and body text
  - View main topics, topics with subtopics, or entire text

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

To use the Outlining feature to organize document content:

1. Open the file **Tech_08.docx** located in the Project.08 folder included with your Data Files and then, to avoid altering the original file, save the document as **Partnership Proposal** in the same folder. The document contains the text of a proposal between two companies to form a partnership.
2. Click the **Show/Hide** ¶ button ¶ in the **Paragraph** group to show the paragraph marks, if necessary.
3. Click the **View** tab, and then click the **Outline** button in the Document Views group. In Outline view, you can assign levels to each heading and subheading. You assign Level 1 to the main headings, Level 2 to the subheadings under a main heading, Level 3 to the next level of subheadings, and so on. You can apply headings to nine levels; however, for most documents, three or at the most four levels are sufficient.
4. Press the **PgDn** key, click to the left of **Introduction** to position the insertion point, and then click the **Promote to Heading 1** button in the Outline Tools group. The heading is formatted as a Level 1 heading.

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

5. Click in the paragraph of text below Introduction, click the **Demote to Body Text** button in the Outline Tools group, click after the phrase **agreement will be negotiated.** at the end of the paragraph, press the **Enter** key, click the **Promote to Heading 1** button, type **Partnership Requirements**, and then press the **Enter** key.
6. Click the **Demote to Body Text** button, and then type **This section provides background information about PM Connections and Skill Mart and discusses how the partnership could benefit both companies.**
7. Click to the left of **Background Information**, click the **Promote to Heading 1** button once to move the heading to Level 1, and then click the **Demote** button once to move the heading to Level 2.
8. Click in the paragraph below the Background Information heading, and then click the **Demote to Body Text** button.
9. Apply outlining levels to the remaining headings and subheadings, as shown in Figure 8-9, and demote all the paragraphs of text to body text.

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

Heading Text	Level
PM Connections	3
Skill Mart	3
Benefits	2
PM Connections	3
Skill Mart	3
Financial Considerations	1
Projected Revenues	2
Financing Required	2
Proposed Seminars	1
PM Connections Seminars	2
Skill Mart Seminars	2
Conclusion	1

▶ **10.** Scroll up to view the Benefits subheading, and then save the document.

Figure 8-9 Levels for headings and subheadings

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

To edit a document structure in Outline view:

1. Click the **Show Level** list arrow in the Outline Tools group, and then click **Level 3**. Only the three levels of headings are displayed.
2. Move your mouse pointer over the **plus sign** to the right of Financial Considerations and then click to select Financial Considerations and the two subheadings associated with it. The text associated with all three headings is also selected.
3. Click and drag the mouse down until a line appears above the Conclusion heading, and then release the mouse button. The selected text appears above the Conclusion heading, as shown in Figure 8-10. You can also click the Move Up button and Move Down button to move selected headings in Outline view.

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

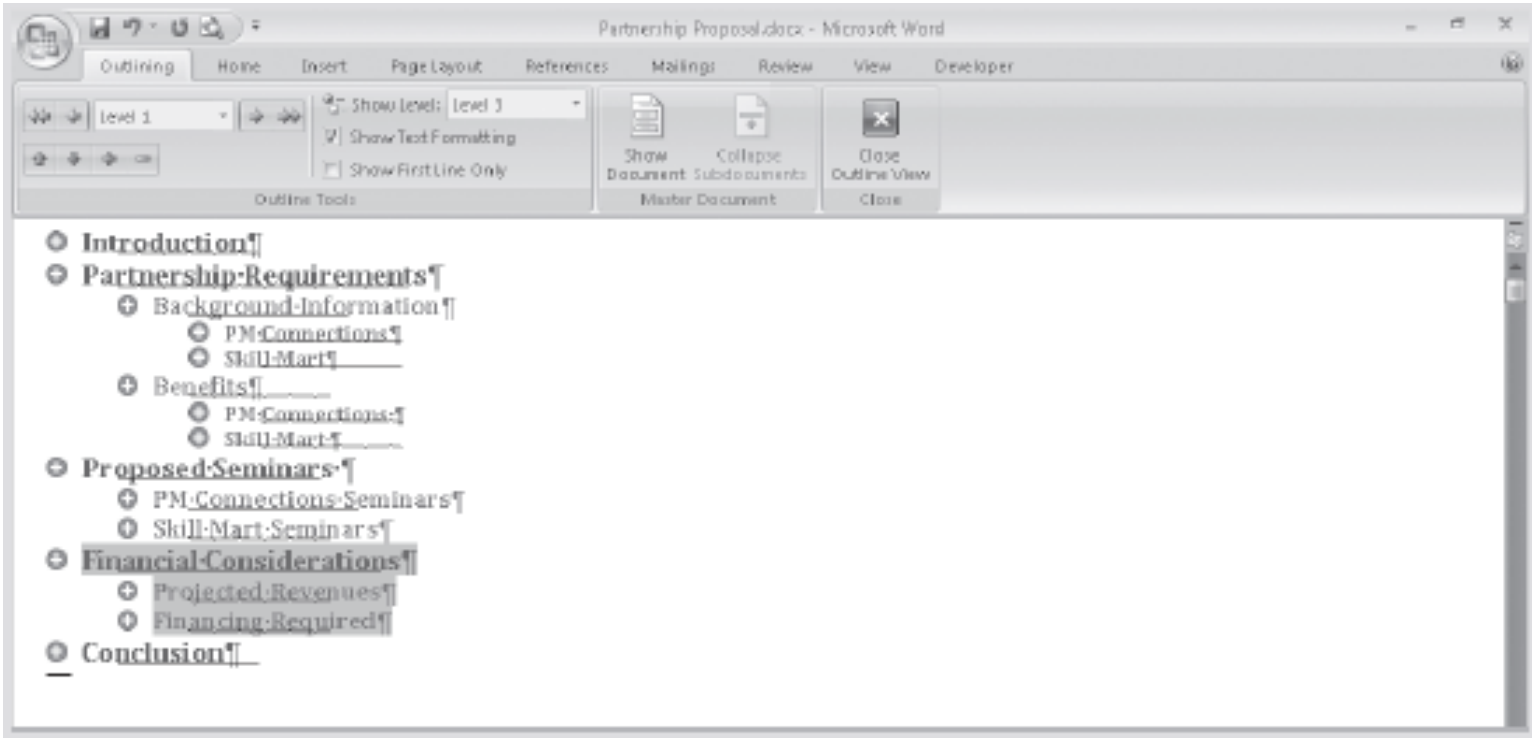


Figure 8-10 Moving text in Outline view

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

4. Double-click the **plus sign** next to the Financial Considerations heading to expand only the subheadings and text associated with that heading.
5. Click the **Collapse** button in the Outline Tools group two times to collapse the heading so only Financial Considerations appears. The other two headings and the text associated with them still exist; however, you hide them so that you can more easily analyze the structure of the document and move sections around.
6. Click the **Show Level** list arrow, click **Level 1** to show only the five main headings in the document, click the **Show Level** list arrow again, and then click **Level 2**.
7. Click the **Show Level** list arrow, and then click **All Levels** to show all the headings, subheadings, and accompanying text again.
8. Save the document.

Figure 8-10 Moving text in Outline view (cont'd.)

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

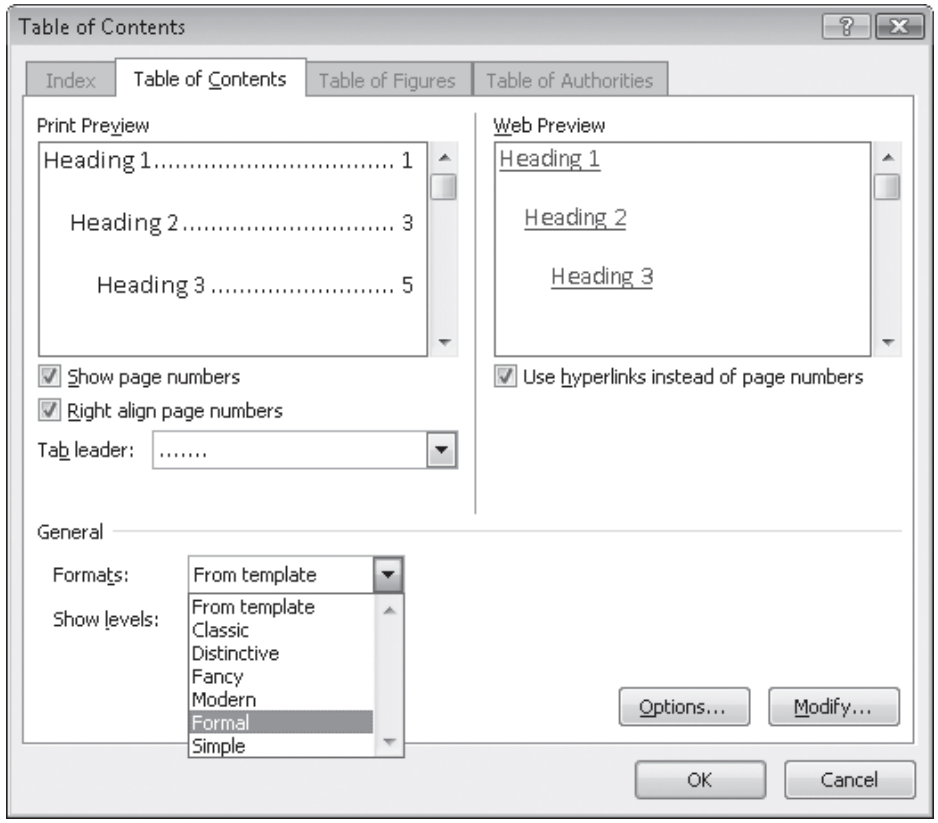
- Table of Contents:
  - Provides readers with a road map
  - Readers can see at a glance the major headings and subheadings
  - Can quickly determine page number of a specific section
  - Use Table of Contents feature in Word only if you format the headings and subheadings in a document with styles

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

To add a table of contents to a document:

1. Click the **Close Outline View** button in the Close group to return to Print Layout view, and then scroll to the Introduction. As you can see, the headings and sub-headings are attractively formatted with the default heading styles.
2. Click to the left of Introduction, press [**Ctrl**][**Enter**], press the **up** arrow ↑ once, type **Table of Contents**, and then press the **Enter** key three times.
3. Select the text **Table of Contents**, format the text with **Bold**, **20-point**, and **Center** alignment, and then click to the left of the **paragraph mark** above the page break. Now your insertion point is in position to generate the table of contents.
4. Click the **References** tab, click **Table of Contents** in the Table of Contents group, click **Insert Table of Contents**, click the **Formats** list arrow, and then click **Formal**, as shown in Figure 8-11.

Organizing Content (cont'd.)



5. Click **OK**, and then save the document. The table of contents appears.

Figure 8-11 Selecting a format in the Table of Contents dialog box

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

- Divide the proposal into three sections
- Use different page numbering options for each section as follows:
  - Section 1: title page
    - Should not include page number
  - Section 2: table of contents page
    - Should include page number
  - Section 3: text of proposal
    - Should include a page number formatted in the 1, 2, 3 style starting on page 1

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

To divide a document into sections:

1. Press [**Ctrl**][**Home**] to move to the top of the document, press [**Ctrl**][**F**] to open the Find and Replace dialog box, click **More**, click **Special**, click **Manual Page Break**, and then click **Find Next**. You save time by using the Find command to search for the manual page break so you can replace it with a section break.
2. Move the dialog box so you can see the page break, click the selected text in the document (the page break), press the **Delete** key to remove the page break, click the **Page Layout** tab, click **Breaks** in the Page Setup group, and then click **Next Page** in the Section Breaks area to create a Next Page section break.
3. Click **Find Next** in the Find and Replace dialog box, close the Find and Replace dialog box, and then replace the page break between pages 2 and 3 with a Next Page section break. The document is now divided into three sections.
4. If necessary, press the **Delete** key to remove the extra paragraph mark above Introduction on page 3, and then save the document.

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

To add headers, footers, and page numbers:

1. Scroll to and click anywhere on the table of contents page, click the **Insert** tab, click **Footer**, click the **Blank** option, press the **Delete** key two times to remove the text placeholder, and then click the **Link to Previous** button in the Navigation group. You deselect Link to Previous because you do not want the page number you enter in the footer to also appear in section 1 of the document. By default, the Link to Previous button is selected.
2. Type **your name**, press the **Tab** key twice, click the **Page Number** button in the Header & Footer group, point to **Current Position**, and then click **Plain Number**.
3. Click the **Page Number** button in the Header & Footer group again, click **Format Page Numbers**, click the **Number format** list arrow in the Page Number Format dialog box, and then select **i,ii,iii** as shown in Figure 8-12.

Organizing Content (cont'd.)

4. Click the **Start at** option button, click **OK**, and then click the **Next Section** button in the Navigation group to move to the footer for Section 3 of the proposal document. At present, a *2* appears in the footer and the Link to Previous button is again selected. You do not want the number in the footer to be linked to the text in the footer in section 2 because you want the number to be *1* instead of *2*.
5. Click the **Link to Previous** button to deselect it, click the **Page Number** button in the Header & Footer group, click **Format Page Numbers**, click the **Start at** option button, and then click **OK**. Your name appears at the left margin and a *1* now appears in the footer for page 1 of the proposal text.
6. Click **Go to Header** in the Navigation group, click the **Link to Previous** button to deselect it, type **Partnership Agreement Proposal**, select the text, center and bold the text, and then click **Close Header and Footer** in the Close group on the Header & Footer Design Tools tab.
7. Right-click the **table of contents**, click **Update Field**, click the **Update entire table** option button, and then click **OK**. Now the page number *1* appears next to Introduction. If you remove any text from the document, you can update the table of contents again and the new page numbers will be generated.
8. Type your name where indicated on the title page, save the document, print a copy, and then close the document.